The Keeper of Saltmere Light

A short guide to the lighthouse on Saltmere Point, written as test material for the RAG Book Library.

Chapter 1: The Lighthouse

Saltmere Light was built in 1847 by the engineer Agnes Morrow. The tower is 31 metres tall and was painted with red and white bands so that ships could recognise it during the day.

The original lamp burned whale oil. In 1902 it was replaced by a paraffin vapour burner, and in 1958 the station was finally connected to electricity.

Chapter 2: Daily Duties of the Keeper

The keeper climbed the 142 steps of the tower at sunset to light the lamp. Every morning the lens was polished with a soft linen cloth and the brass fittings were cleaned with vinegar.

The keeper recorded the weather three times a day in the station logbook: at six in the morning, at noon, and at six in the evening.

Supplies Delivered Each Month

Item	Quantity	Purpose
Paraffin	40 litres	Fuel for the lamp
Linen cloths	12	Polishing the lens
Candles	30	Lighting the stairs

Chapter 3: The Great Storm of 1911

On the night of 14 October 1911 a storm drove the fishing boat Marigold towards the rocks below the point. The keeper, Thomas Hale, kept the lamp burning through the night and fired distress rockets every fifteen minutes.

At dawn the lifeboat from Penhallow village rescued all seven crew members. Thomas Hale was later awarded a silver medal for his courage.